

How do you read the table? I know your eyes probably glaze over when you see a table swimming with numbers, but consider the bull market, up breakout column. A quarter of the patterns fail to climb more than 15%.

Downward breakouts in bull markets have the highest failure rates: 58% fail to see price drop more than 10%.

Say you want to shoot for the moon and make 50%. How many triangles perform that well after an upward breakout in a bull market? Answer: 23%. That is, 77% will fail to see price rise more than 50%.

[Table 66.4](#) shows breakout-related statistics.

Breakout direction. The trend followers have the most breakouts. That's bull market/upward breakouts and bear market/down breakouts.

Yearly position, performance. Where do the best performing triangles appear? Las Vegas? Atlantic City? No. Apparently the answer is all over because the table shows only a mild preference for those within a third of the yearly low in the two right columns.

You will want to avoid those patterns with breakouts within a third of the yearly high. Even so, in many cases the performance difference between the values isn't wide.

Apex distance. The median distance from the start of the triangle to the breakout is in the low-to-mid-70s.

Throwbacks and pullbacks. Throwbacks and pullbacks occur about two-thirds of the time. Price trends for 5 or 6 days before making the return trip back to the breakout price for a round-trip of 10 to 12 days.

When triangles have throwbacks or pullbacks, performance suffers. That's true in all columns. For example, triangles in bull markets that throw back show rises averaging 30%. Without a throwback, the rise averages 41%.

To avoid a throwback or pullback, look for nearby (within 10% away) overhead resistance or underlying support before trading the triangle.

Gaps. In three of four columns, the appearance of a breakout day gap helps performance, not by a lot, but some. I calculate performance using the opening price the day *after* a gap, so you don't have to own the stock to participate in better performance for patterns showing a gap.